

LECTURE NO 15: *Project Communications Management*

Communications Management

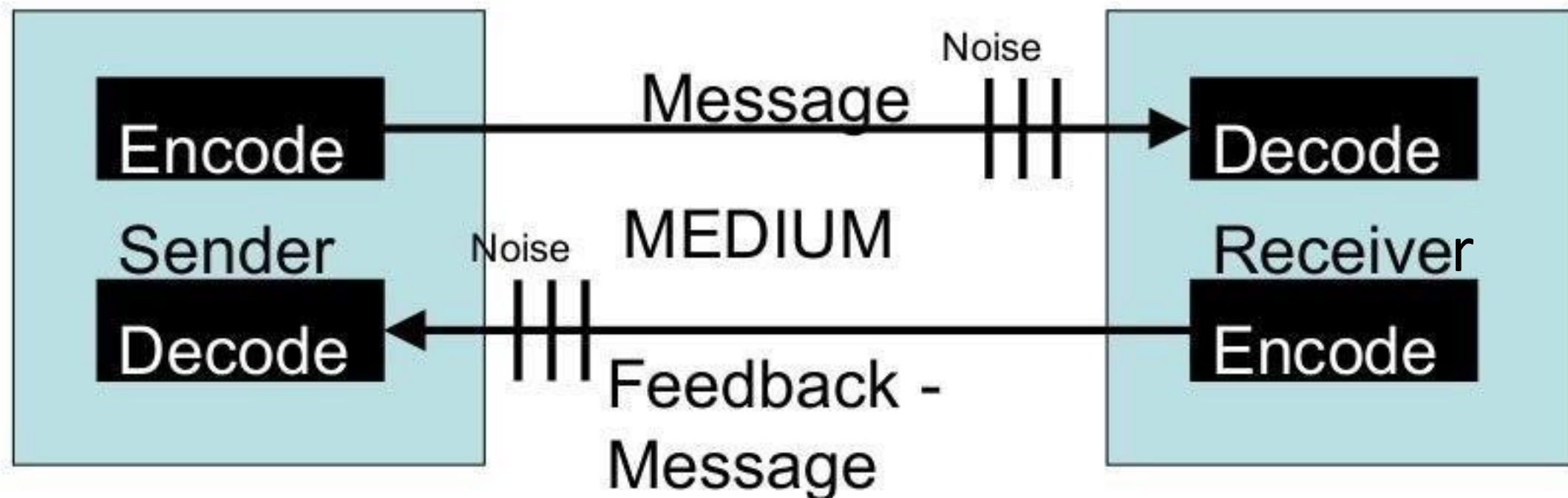
- The processes required to ensure timely and appropriate generation, collection, distribution, storage, recovery, and ultimate disposition of project information

Why Do We Manage Communications?

- Project Managers spend most of their time communicating
- Communication is complex; requiring choices between:
 - Sender-Receiver models
 - Choice of media
 - Writing style
 - Presentation techniques
 - Meeting management

Communication Model

- Encode – Translate thought to language
- Message – Output of encoding
- Medium – Method to convey message
- Noise – Interference with transmission/understanding
- Decode – Translation back to thought/idea



Communication Model

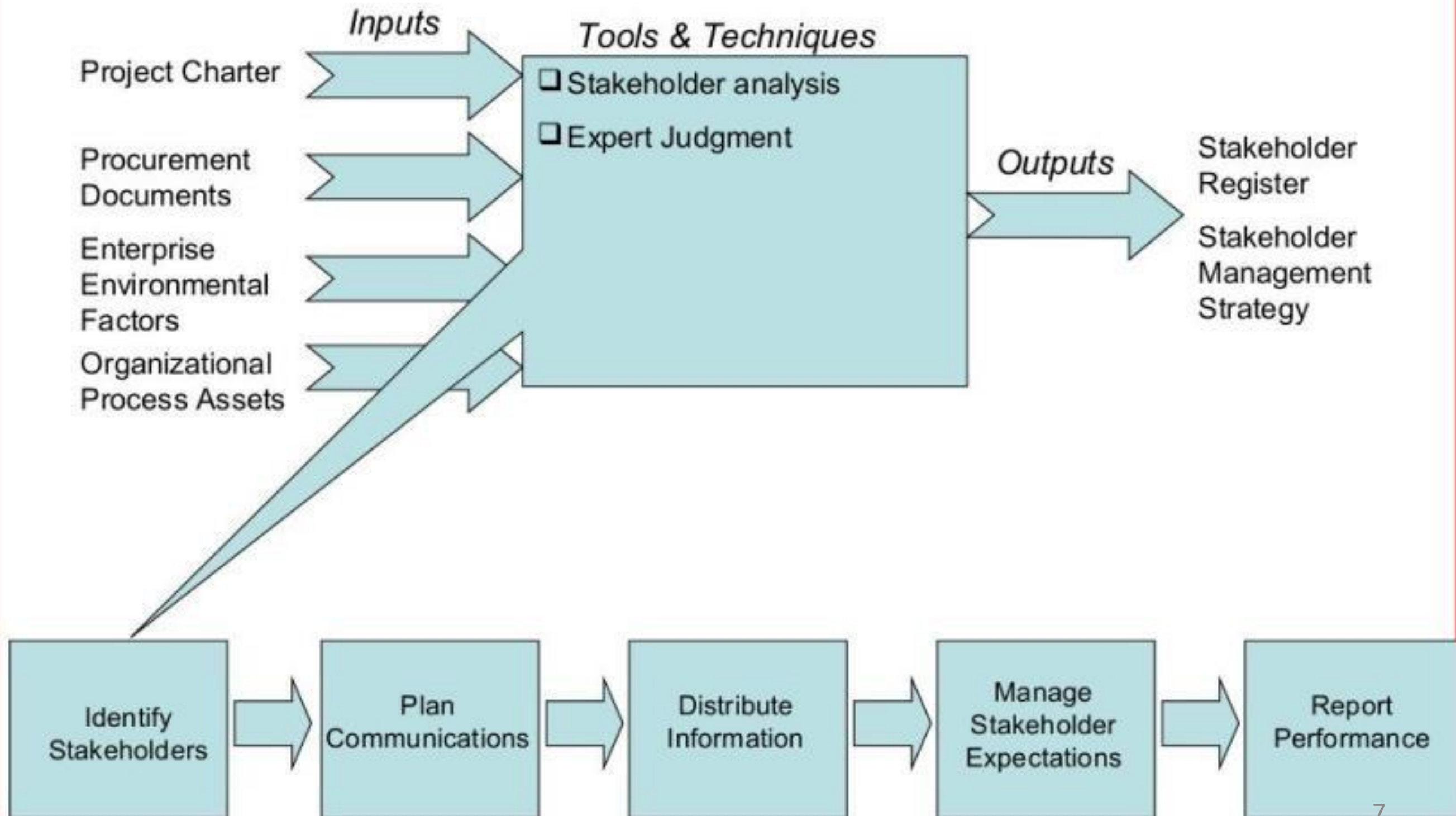
- Communication model implies feedback required
- Key Terms
 - Nonverbal – 55% of Communication
 - Paralingual – Pitch and tone of voice
 - Active listening – Receiver confirms message and asks for clarification
 - Effective listening – Receiver pays attention, thoughtfully responds, and provides feedback

How Do We Manage Communications?

- Five processes
 - Identify Stakeholders
 - Plan Communications
 - Distribute Information
 - Manage Stakeholder Expectations
 - Report Performance



Identify Stakeholders



Identify Stakeholders

- **Identifying stakeholders**-The process of identifying all people or organizations impacted by the project, and documenting relevant information regarding their interest, involvement and impact on project success.
- **Stakeholder Analysis**- A technique of systematically gathering and analyzing quantitative and qualitative information to determine whose interests should be taken into account throughout the project.
- **Stakeholder Register**

Name	Contact Information	Role in Project	Department/ Supervisor	Company	Impact	Influence	Main expectations	Attitude about the project	Major requirement

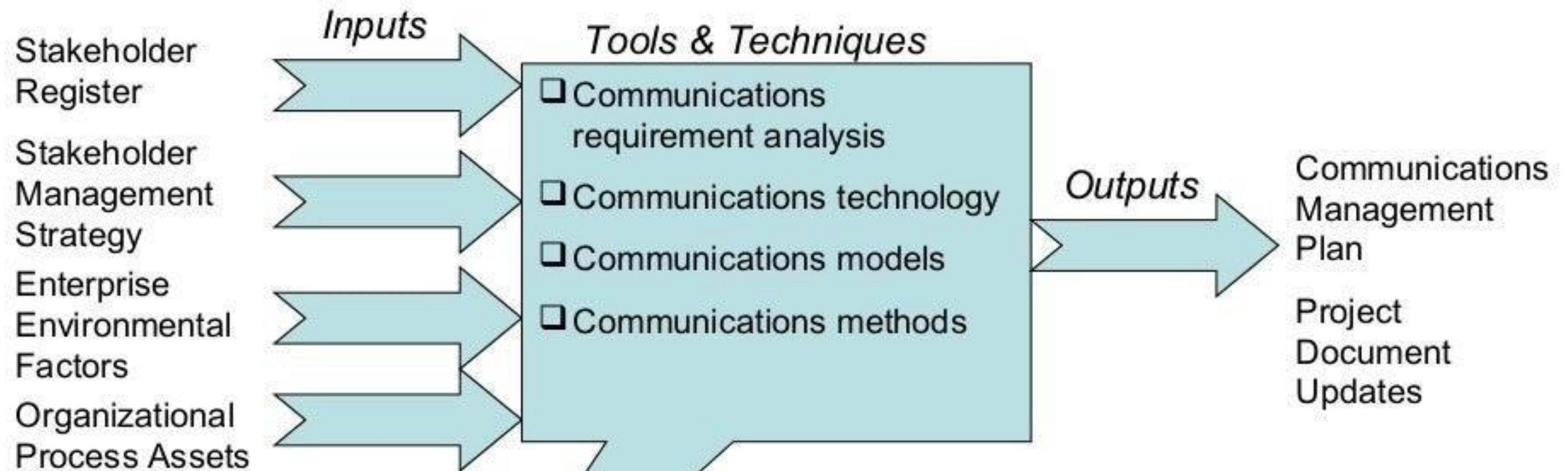
Identify Stakeholders

Stakeholder Management Strategy:

- Defines an approach to increase the support and minimize negative impacts of stakeholder.
- The information could be too sensitive to be shared.

Stakeholder	Stakeholder interest(s) in the project	Assessment of impact	Potential strategies for gaining support or reducing obstacles

Plan Communications



90% of project manager's time is spent for communication



Plan Communications

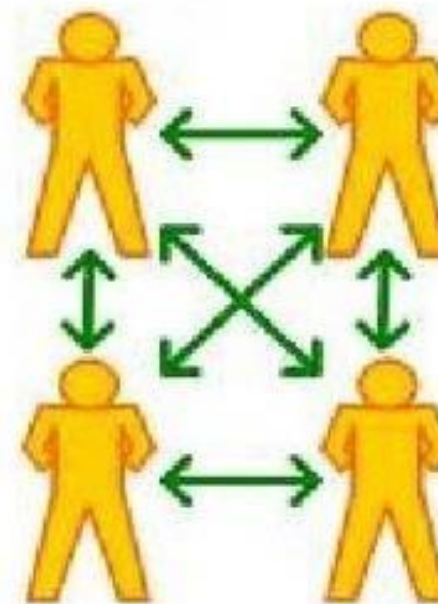
- The process of determining the project stakeholder information needs and defining a communication approach.

Communication Requirement Analysis

- Includes communicating in all directions



- Consider the number of potential **communication channels** or paths



Communication channels grow exponentially not linearly as team members are added!

- Determine and limit who will communicate with whom and who will receive what information.

- Formula:

For calculating number of communication channels

$$\frac{N(N-1)}{2}$$

N = Number of Stakeholders

Plan Communications

Communication Methods

- Interactive Communication
 - Most efficient way to ensure a common understanding
 - E.g. meetings, phone calls, video conferencing
- Push Communication
 - Does not certify that it reached or understood
 - E.g. letters, email, press release, faxes, voice mail
- Pull communication
 - Used for very large information volumes, very large audiences
 - E.g. intranet site, e-learning



Project manager cannot control all communications but should try to control to prevent miscommunication, unclear directions, and scope creeps.

Plan Communications

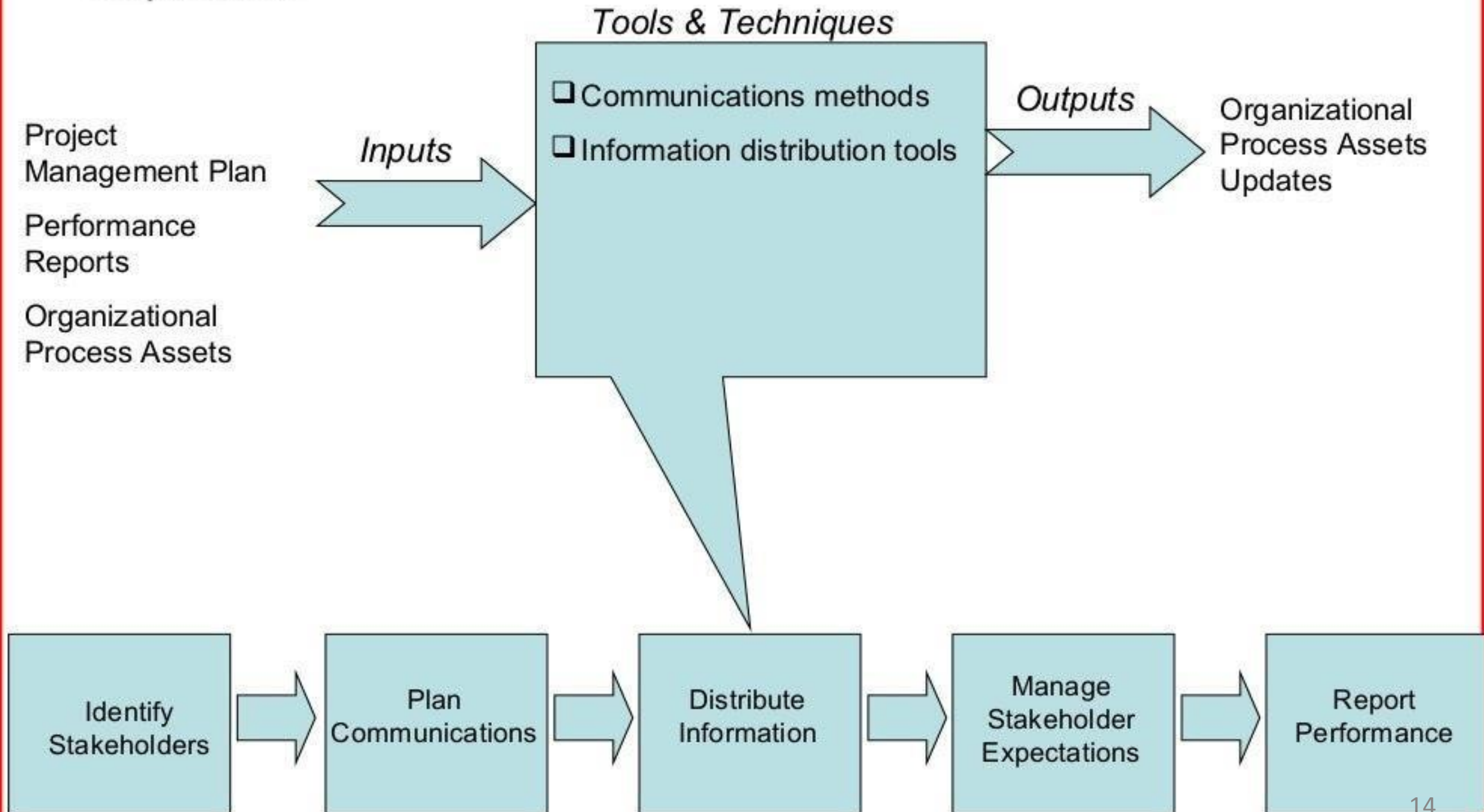
Communication Management Plan

Sample

What	Who/Target	Purpose	When/Frequency	Type/Method(s)
Initiation Meeting	All stakeholders**	Gather information for Initiation Plan	FIRST Before Project Start Date	Meeting
Distribute Project Initiation Plan	All stakeholders**	Distribute Plan to alert stakeholders of project scope and to gain buy in.	Before Kick Off Meeting Before Project Start Date	Document distributed via hardcopy or electronically. May be posted on project website or OIT Blackboard site.
Project Kick Off	All stakeholders**	Communicate plans and stakeholder roles/responsibilities. Encourage communication among stakeholders.	At or near Project Start Date	Meeting
Status Reports	All stakeholders and Project Office	Update stakeholders on progress of the project.	Regularly Scheduled. Monthly is recommended for large/midsize projects.	Distribute electronically and post via web/OIT Blackboard site. Template: Status Report
Team Meetings	Entire Project Team. Individual meetings for sub-teams, technical team, and Functional teams as appropriate.	To review detailed plans (tasks, assignments, and action items).	Regularly Scheduled. Weekly is recommended for entire team. Weekly or bi-weekly for sub-teams as appropriate.	Meeting

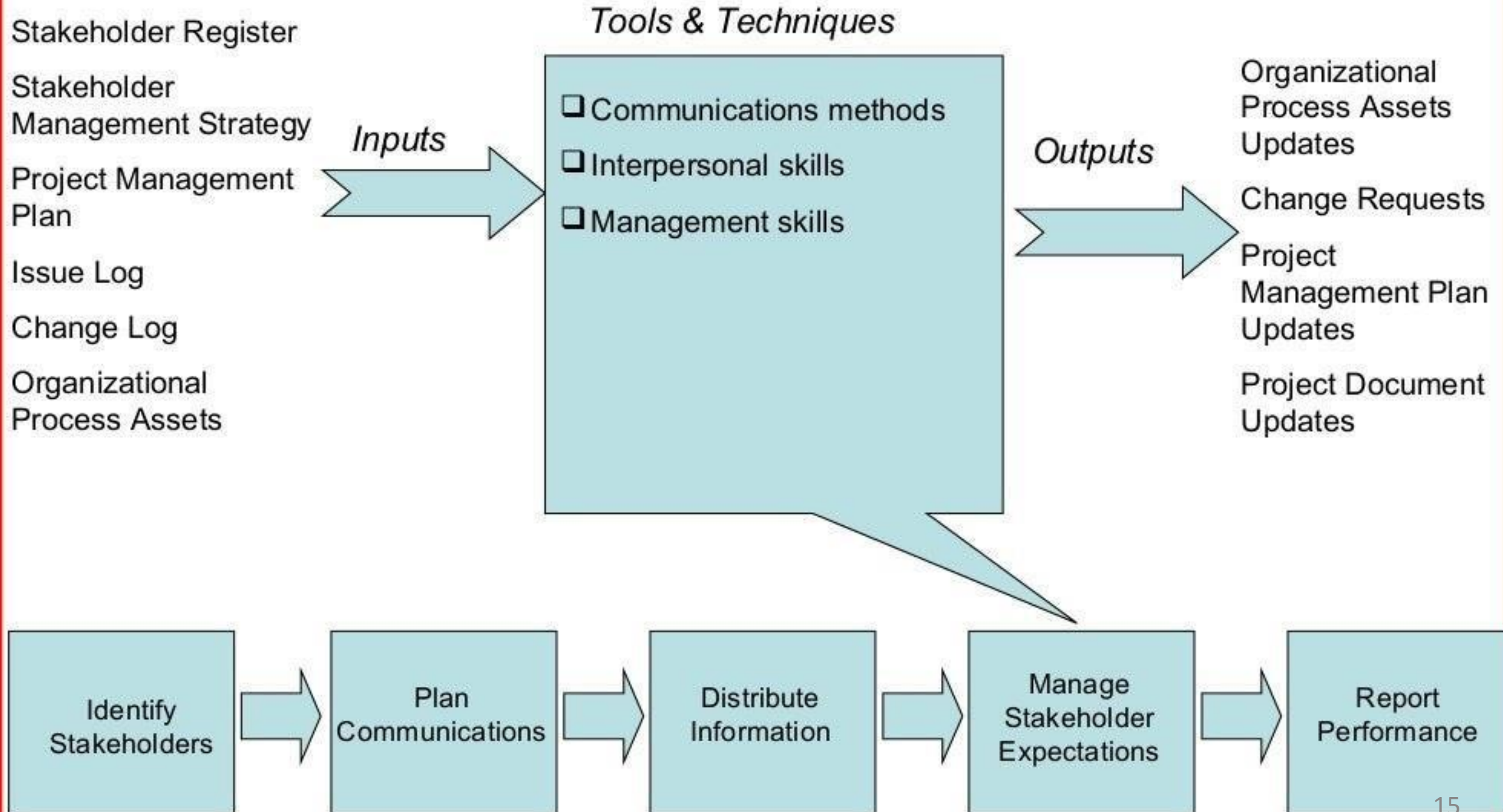
Distribute Information

- The process of making relevant information available to project stakeholders as planned.



Manage Stakeholder Expectations

- The process of communicating and working with stakeholders to meet their needs and addressing issues as they occur.



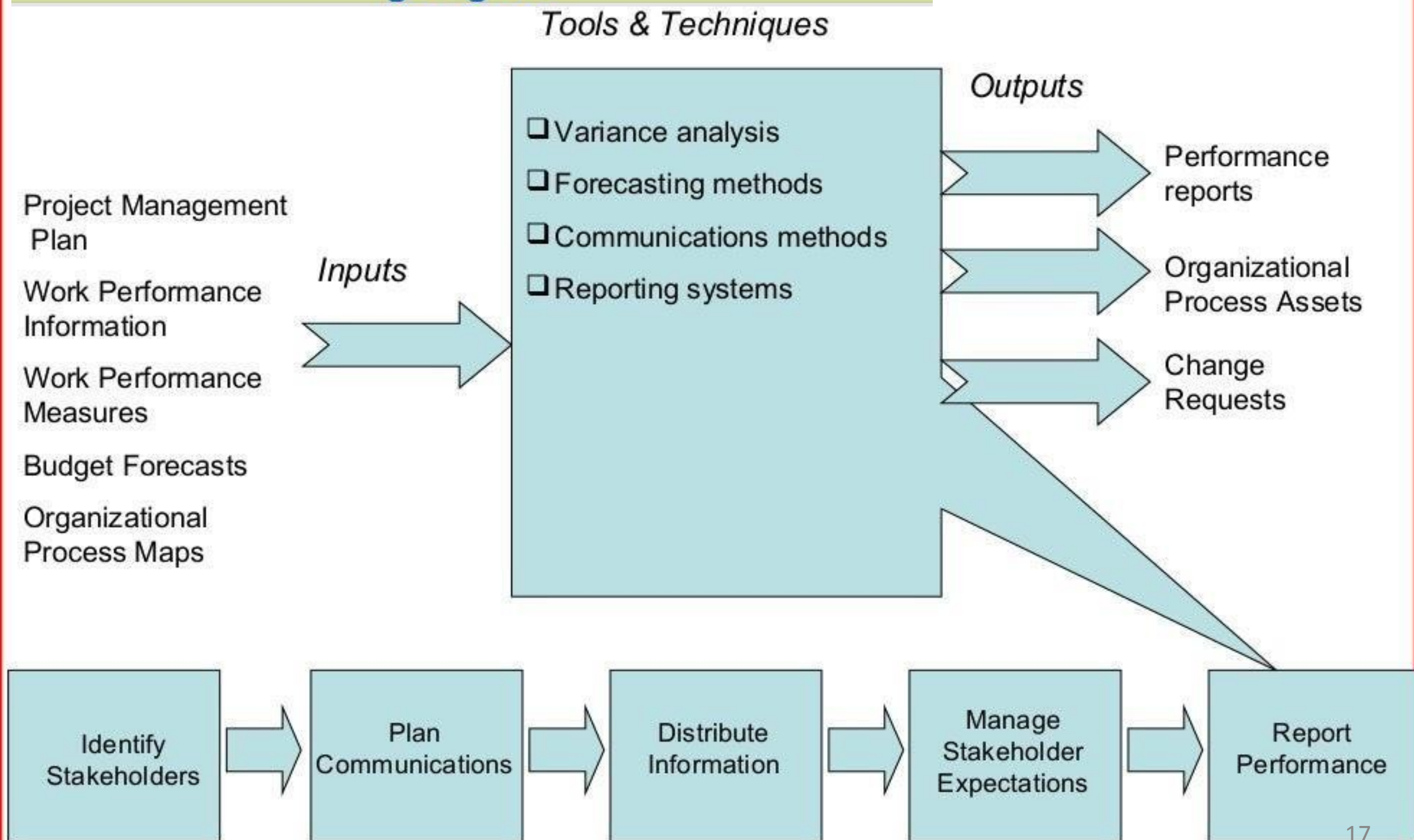
Manage Stakeholder Expectations

Managing Stakeholder Expectations

- Actively managing the expectation of stakeholders.
 - Increase the likelihood of project acceptance by negotiating.
 - Influencing their desire to achieve & maintain project goals.
- Addressing concerns that have not become issues yet (anticipation).
- Clarifying and resolving issues that have been identified.

Report Performance

Report must be truthful and not hide what is really going on.



Reference

† ~~S.~~ Harold Kerzner, *“Project Management, A System Approach to Planning, Scheduling & Controlling”*, 12th Edition, Wiley.

† James. P. Lewis *“Project Planning, Scheduling, and Control”*, 3rd Edition, McGraw-Hill Companies.

† Timothy J. Kloppenborg, Vittal Anantatmula, Kathryn N. Wells, *“Contemporary Project Management”* 4th Edition, Cengage Learning.